Discovery engine: answers to the brief's questions

Generated by `engine/ask.py` with `openai:gpt-5.4-nano` over the tagged sample (799 items, 490 relevant).

Each answer cites corpus item ids; look them up in the dashboard's *Read the voices* tab or in `data/store/*.jsonl`. The engine declines when it finds fewer than 5 evidence items. A grounding check lists any cited id that is not in the evidence.

These answers are qualitative: each reads the 40 most relevant tagged posts, so "well supported" means within those posts. How common each reason is comes from the tagged counts instead (deck slide 3: failed payments 29% of stop signals, markets 15%).

Why do people start a SIP, and what do they expect to happen?

- **People start SIPs to build savings/invest for the future gradually, especially when they don't have money upfront** ("hope… build their future slowly, with sacrifice and patience") [youtube-UgzefxoKOfZo1ZschNl4AaABAg] and as a way to **secure present & future for family/goals** [youtube-UgyTidVY9tg5AOFCLeB4AaABAg].
- **They expect SIP to create wealth through compounding/regular investing, without needing perfect timing**, e.g., to keep investing through corrections and not wait for downturns [valuepickr-356459]. Some also frame SIP as a habit that supports long-term growth [youtube-UgxNsbLp3Gx2I75f7kl4AaABAg].
- **Some expect SIP to be suitable for converting into withdrawals (income) later in life**, e.g., "SIP… convert karke… withdrawals" monthly after a long horizon [youtube-UgzJc3rrg6DeDaUdEoR4AaABAg].
- **Weak/negative signals: several people imply they start with expectations of good returns, but experience disappointments or fear future underperformance**—claims include **returns not meeting expectations** and higher expenses reducing returns [youtube-Ugzw_FPZlf37eGru4YR4AaABAg], **plans turning flat/negative for months** [reddit-1qtqk4t], and concerns that returns may become worse vs bank FD [youtube-Ugz-Bx_SmLFxi_cIRkt4AaABAg]. (These are fewer than the motivational/start motivations.)
- **Specific expectation-gap examples:** one investor says their SIP was ended due to **small overall gain vs FD** and that rebalancing/market effects worked against them [reddit-1w43pk6]. Another says their goal timeline ("5–6 years… down-payment") took longer than expected and is considering stopping [reddit-1xdybj4].

Confidence: **medium** — multiple items clearly support "why start" (habit/hope/goal security/compounding), but evidence about "what people expect to happen" is mixed: expectations are present, yet return-expectation outcomes are only supported by a smaller set of negative/experience-gap items.

Evidence items: 40 · cited: 10 · unknown ids: 0

What changes in their behaviour in the months after starting?

- **Some users report payment/SIP execution problems continuing or worsening after starting** (e.g., autopay mandate issues, failed deductions, delays, and refunds not resolving quickly). Examples include "autopay… transaction failed… refund" with money "blocked for almost 20 days" [playstore-2251220b38ea], "2 months SIP did not get deducted… no resolution" [playstore-ce74faa21e21], and "80%… unsuccessful" SIP transactions [playstore-6d0888dacaf6].
- **Behaviors/choices change after early issues**: at least one user **stops SIP** due to performance concerns ("stopped SIP… until… allocate…") [reddit-1rgybe9], and others describe switching/reassessing portfolios after losses (e.g., "moved… recently… flat/negative since the past 3/4 months" and "total returns reduced") [reddit-1qtqea5].
- **Some users describe growing operational friction over time** (e.g., confusion around SIP payment flow/autopay requirements and difficulty managing bank attachment). One user says payment UX "forces use to make autopay" and prevents deleting the bank until another is added [playstore-ae93fd10c628].
- **A minority report continued positive experiences rather than negative behavioral changes**: e.g., "continue the good work" after 6–12 months with customer support "reply within time" [appstore-673b7599390b], and another

says they were skeptical at first but later found “legitimacy and transparency” and “got hooked” [appstore-a3a951ff8357].

- **Weak/limited signal on “behavior changes” specifically in the months after starting**: the evidence mostly captures *issue reports and portfolio return reactions* rather than clear month-by-month behavioral shifts.

Confidence: **medium** — evidence supports changes like stopping SIP/rebalancing and continuing payment/SIP problems, but it’s not consistently month-by-month and “behavior changes after starting” isn’t directly measured in most items.

Evidence items: 25 · cited: 8 · unknown ids: 0

What leads investors to pause, reduce or stop a SIP?

- **Market downturn / volatility + negative performance** is a common reason investors pause or reduce SIPs: e.g., “sudden, significant falls” and fund underperformance leading to cutting SIPs [reddit-19rjciwerm9pf], SIPs stopped after negative returns [quora-deb2de91e325], and SIP paused after returns turned negative [reddit-1rgy98l]. *(Well supported: appears across multiple items.)*
- **Personal cashflow / job / expense stress** drives reductions or stopping SIPs: one user stopped SIPs after losing a job [reddit-1nyk060] and another reduced SIP allocation due to “additional monthly expenses” / extra financial needs [reddit-1vry1oz]. *(Moderately supported: seen in several separate accounts.)*
- **Operational/fund-structure constraints cause pauses** (investor wants to invest but SIP can’t/doesn’t run): examples include fund house pauses/suspensions due to rules/limits [reddit-pcl11yx], overseas investment limit causing suspension [reddit-pcl11yx], and “MO S&P 500 was paused… wasn’t resumed automatically… Today… manually” [tradingqna-405535]. *(Moderate support; fewer items but directly about “why SIP stopped/paused.”)*
- **Payment mandate or execution failures** lead to stopping/skipping or inability to run SIP: failed SIP deductions / mandate issues [reddit-1wywyl7] and issues with autopay confirmation/rejection [appstore-69ff857faf11]. *(Moderately supported: multiple items describe mandate/payment problems.)*
- **Preference for simplifying / changing strategy** leads to stopping SIPs even if not forced: e.g., stopping a SIP and moving to individual stocks [reddit-1w43pk6], or stopping/reallocating between funds due to overlap/portfolio adjustments [reddit-1rgy98l]. *(Weak-to-moderate: fewer items, but present.)*
- **“Skip SIP while fund is at peak / timing”** appears in at least one signal: “skipped my some SIP since they are in highest return peak” [youtube-Ugz0fbZBmQ4hyVnr7qV4AaABAg]. *(Weak: only 1 item.)*

Confidence: **medium — why**: Several categories (market drawdowns, cashflow/job stress, mandate/payment failures, and fund-house pauses) are each supported by multiple items, but the dataset has many “unclear” posts and no item directly quantifies overall frequency across investors.

Evidence items: 40 · cited: 11 · unknown ids: 0

What do investors check, and how often, once they have started?

- **Investors check their investments/portfolio periodically, but frequency varies a lot.** Some say they check **quarterly/“once in 3 months”** [valuepickr-270981], while others report checking statements more frequently (e.g., noticing dashboard/statement mismatches “since beginning” of their experience) [appstore-97ae5f26b02e].
- **After starting, many investors also check performance during market ups/downs—sometimes daily/regularly.** One YouTube comment describes people watching performance **daily on the app** and withdrawing during falls [youtube-UgxAMSRo5eQk-ezYlC94AaABAg ⚠ not in evidence]. Another expresses anxiety/“profit swaha… money katega” behavior (emotion linked to short-term changes) [youtube-Ugwl4WooEvsSrlevszx4AaABAg].
- **Operations/automation issues lead to “how often” checks like statements, SIP deductions, and app status.** Examples include checking SIP deduction timing (weekly SIP not deducted on schedule; app shows “In Progress/Pending”) [reddit-1wywyl7], and checking/update correctness when money is debited early or transactions don’t update correctly [playstore-6aca67a0c9c2], and checking statements when invested amounts differ from dashboard [appstore-97ae5f26b02e].

- **Weak/partial signals: Some investors explicitly reduce or stop "visiting" platforms because SIP is automated.** One Reddit/T&Q post says they stopped visiting a platform because SIPs are automated, though resumption still required manual action [tradingqna-405535].
- **We don't have enough evidence to quantify "how often" across investors after start (e.g., weekly vs monthly counts).** The dataset includes **several individual anecdotes** about checking frequency [valuepickr-270981] [youtube-UgxAMSRo5eQk-ezYlC94AaABAg ⚠ not in evidence] [appstore-97ae5f26b02e], but it's not a representative measurement of the investor population.

Confidence: **medium — why:** The evidence clearly shows *what* people check (statements/dashboard, SIP deduction status, performance tracking, and company/investment developments) and includes some frequency examples (daily watching, quarterly checking, statement checking since beginning), but it lacks enough items to reliably summarize **overall "how often" after start** with counts.

Evidence items: 23 · cited: 6 · unknown ids: 1

What confuses or worries them inside the app?

- **App behavior feels unreliable / unclear status updates** (e.g., investments deducted but not reflected; SIP status like "In Progress/Pending" unclear; SIPs stop tracking or SIPs fail "randomly") [playstore-417353e7f6c2] [playstore-e2acab260577] [playstore-2846091dd48c] [playstore-c57f05b4a00a] [reddit-1wywyl7] [playstore-6bdc29a68c3a]
- **Payment/autopay & SIP mandate problems worry them**: SIPs fail, mandates get rejected, transactions are unsuccessful, deductions happen but later show failure, or cancellations still lead to charges/bounces [tradingqna-457215] [playstore-dfa428a5c40e] [playstore-138eb726b79b] [playstore-7a0ba2e0aedc] [playstore-6d0888dacaf6] [playstore-2251220b38ea] [playstore-6bdc29a68c3a]
- **Refunds not arriving (or arriving late) creates major worry/confusion**—users describe missing money after debits, refunds taking longer than promised, and "fake commitments" [playstore-417353e7f6c2] [playstore-138eb726b79b] [playstore-dfa428a5c40e] [playstore-511ebaf79a1a] [playstore-e80e2f357118]
- **Customer support experience is a concern**: people can't reach support, get bot/template responses, tickets get closed without resolution, or support gives unhelpful/sales-pitch answers [playstore-b36091b3ec80] [playstore-ce74faa21e21] [playstore-035aba32bd67] [playstore-69ff857faf11 ⚠ not in evidence] [appstore-2db07a46bf38]
- **Trust/"transparency" worries** appear: users feel misled about fund/product details (e.g., demat/statement mismatch; exit load/redemption terms; "smart save" redemption conditions; regular vs direct funds) [appstore-2db07a46bf38] [playstore-8598c8acf9c6] [playstore-a7649c9513b0] [playstore-31364467b898]
- **UI/feature clutter confuses some users** after more features were added beyond investing (makes the app feel cluttered) [appstore-540d41b690eb]

Well supported vs weak signals: The strongest/most repeated themes are **payment/SIP mandate failures** and **refund/support issues** (many items). Less frequent but still present are **portfolio/dashboard inaccuracies** and **product transparency/terms confusion** (fewer items).

Confidence: **high — why:** Most concerns are directly stated across many evidence items with consistent topics (SIP/payment failures, missing/late refunds, and unhelpful support).

Evidence items: 40 · cited: 22 · unknown ids: 1

What do they do outside the app when they feel unsure?

- **They ask for advice outside the app (Reddit/community posts).** Multiple entries describe people feeling unsure and then seeking feedback/perspectives from others (e.g., restarting/stopping SIPs, reacting to negative performance, or handling portfolio confusion) [reddit-1tdp2nl] [reddit-1tdp2nl] [reddit-1recw03] [reddit-1w8pj9b] [reddit-1rgybe9].
- **They stop or pause SIPs when uncertain and reassess.** Several users say they stop SIPs after doubt/underperformance or uncertainty, then plan what to do next (e.g., stopping Motilal Midcap SIP, pausing a SIP

to adjust allocation, stopping a SIP and considering switching) [reddit-1recw03] [reddit-1rgybe9] [reddit-1wblus1].

- **They switch/adjust allocations by comparing options.** Uncertainty leads some users to shift from one fund to another (e.g., replacing midcap funds, considering adding debt exposure, or moving SIP money to different funds if a SIP is stopped/failed) [reddit-p7xyulx] [reddit-1recw03] [reddit-1wsf1qx] [reddit-1xog4s3].
- **They troubleshoot/seek support when things don't work (e.g., failed/rejected SIP/mandates).** When unsure due to operational issues, they look for guidance and interpret failures (mandate issues, SIP rejected, UPI/eNACH problems) [reddit-1rng5hl] [reddit-1w43pk6] [reddit-1wsf1qx] [reddit-1r644ki].

Confidence: **medium** — evidence shows users respond to uncertainty mainly by seeking advice on Reddit and changing/stopping SIPs, but the dataset doesn't explicitly list a single consistent "outside the app" behavior for all users.

Evidence items: 40 · cited: 11 · unknown ids: 0

What separates investors who continue from those who quietly drop off?

- **Continuers seem more willing to keep going despite frictions** (e.g., after identifying statement/dashboard errors, continuing SIPs and re-trying after contacting support) [appstore-97ae5f26b02e].
- **Quitters/drop-offs show stronger breakage points around missed/failed SIP payments and app/support failures** —many describe failed first installments, stuck/refund delays, or canceled/disrupted SIPs leading to discontinuation or "stop all SIPs" actions [reddit-1qy5uvi] [appstore-c11d416485a9] [reddit-1wblus1] [playstore-138eb726b79b] (plus multiple "bad customer support / template responses" signals) [appstore-97ae5f26b02e] [playstore-ce74faa21e21] [playstore-3e8a9e76d9b9] (well-supported pattern across multiple items: **~8+ items** describe payment failures/support issues).
- **Continuers appear to maintain or restore discipline when they stop for other reasons** (e.g., they stopped SIP for physical gold purchase, then plan to restart next month) [reddit-1wblus1].
- **Drop-offs also correlate with dissatisfaction with performance/management behavior vs expectations** (quietly stopping SIP after underwhelming gains or perceived manager actions that hurt returns) [reddit-1w43pk6]; other users stop SIPs when performance/risk allocation seems wrong and then adjust [reddit-1rgy98l] [reddit-1wblus1].
- **Some continuers frame SIP as "patience/discipline" rather than short-term outcomes**, suggesting a mindset that reduces urge to quit (e.g., "SIPs continue as planned... Patience is part of the process") [x-2065707866489762013] and continued investing discipline to avoid lapses [valuepickr-270981].

Confidence: **medium — why**: Evidence points to *payment/support failures* and *return/expectation gaps* as common drop-off triggers, and *discipline/mindset* plus *planning to restart* as continuance signals, but the set is not explicitly labeled "continuers vs drop-offs," so separation is inferred from narratives rather than proven causal comparison.

Evidence items: 40 · cited: 11 · unknown ids: 0

How do these patterns differ across user segments?

- **Lower-income / early-career students (often 18–25; smaller SIPs; higher need for guidance) tend to focus on "getting started," basic diversification, and budget-fit adjustments**—e.g., ₹2,000–₹15,000/month SIPs with "new to this" framing and requests to manage overlaps and SIP amounts when expenses change [reddit-1wbfzc4], [reddit-1vry1oz], [reddit-1xhgjkf].
- **Job-risk / income volatility segments prioritize liquidity and pausing/reducing SIPs, then resuming selectively**—one user reduced SIPs by half due to market drops + IT job risk and planned to keep an emergency fund before deploying into funds/US stocks/gold on declines [reddit-19rjciwerm9pf]. Another stopped SIPs after losing job, then planned to restart when circumstances stabilized [reddit-1nyk060].
- **Professionals with longer horizons and higher income show more structured allocation and "portfolio overlap" concerns**, often with explicit multi-bucket equity exposure and rebalancing ideas—e.g., a 28-year-old IT professional lists multiple index/flexi/small-cap allocations and other buckets like EPF/PPF/savings [tradingqna-491514]; a 30-

year-old senior SWE describes a large existing US equity position plus Indian equity mutual funds and emergency/gold [reddit-1wg0osa].

- **Near-term goal segments split SIP across goals (short/intermediate/long) and add "goal-specific" asset choices**, rather than treating everything as one retirement bucket—e.g., a user explicitly breaks SIP into marriage (aggressive hybrid), car (equity savings), and long-term (large/flexi/mid/small + gold) with different horizons [reddit-1w2b22n].
- **Aggressive/high-risk segments often express comfort with drawdowns but still use guidance to avoid certain "caps" (like defensive multi-asset) or over-diversification**—e.g., one explicitly warned that a multi-asset defensive fund may cap growth for an aggressive, younger profile [reddit-pfffa59], and another cautioned against diversifying too much for an ₹8,000 SIP [reddit-pfekatq].
- **Weak/unclear segmentation evidence:** there are only a few items that directly compare the same concept (e.g., "overlap" or "international exposure") across multiple explicitly defined segments; most items are segment-specific but not cross-tabulated. Only a handful clearly map to segment differences like job-loss vs stable career vs near-term goals [reddit-19rjciwerm9pf], [reddit-1nyk060], [reddit-1w2b22n].

Confidence: **medium — why:** The evidence includes multiple clearly distinct segment types (students, job-risk, stable high-income pros, near-term goal planners), but it rarely provides direct, side-by-side comparisons on the same metric, limiting how confidently we can generalize "across segments."

Evidence items: 40 · cited: 10 · unknown ids: 0

What unmet needs emerge consistently across conversations?

- **Cashflow + job/income shock makes people want to pause/reduce SIPs and possibly redeem investments.** This appears in multiple threads where users reduced SIPs due to market drops and job risk, or after losing a job with expenses they can't cover [reddit-19rjciwerm9pf] [reddit-1hvryn1].
- **Trust/UX friction around "managing SIPs" (skip/pause/restart) is a recurring unmet need.** Examples include being unable to restart a SIP because subscriptions are "temporarily suspended," and difficulty skipping/pausing installments (e.g., fund house restrictions) [reddit-1xog4s3] [reddit-1xkj29c] [reddit-1xog4s3].
- **Payment mandate/auto-debit reliability and unclear behavior are consistently frustrating.** Users report insufficient-balance penalties despite "auto" setups, mandates failing, SIP not getting deducted, and confusing status/timing in apps [reddit-1septyi] [reddit-1wywyl7] [quora-e87572824cb9] [reddit-1xqkj8y2 ⚠ not in evidence].
- **Redemption/payment completion issues undermine confidence (money "stuck," delayed, or redemption fails).** Several reviews describe redemption not credited for weeks or failing with errors, plus long wait times / unhelpful support [playstore-ebb37806db50] [playstore-905b24c771f0] [playstore-c499ee3055fb] [playstore-ad4969682b08].
- **App/customer support gaps (poor support, bots, delays) amplify the above problems.** Multiple items mention unresponsive/unprofessional support and BOT-like replies when trying to resolve SIP/redemption problems [playstore-337966d4bc67] [playstore-ce74faa21e21] [playstore-3e8a9e76d9b9].
- **Weak/less consistent signals:** Some conversation about investors checking performance daily during market falls and withdrawing adds to the "behavioral/unmet need" theme, but it's not as repeatedly evidenced as the operational/payment issues [youtube-UgxAMSRo5eQk-ezYlC94AaABAg.AbllYl_ha4MAbqpe1eL3fp].

Confidence: **medium** — multiple clusters (cashflow shock, SIP management friction, mandate failures, redemption delays, poor support) are well represented, but the evidence set doesn't provide a precise count of "unmet needs" beyond these repeated themes.

Evidence items: 40 · cited: 15 · unknown ids: 1